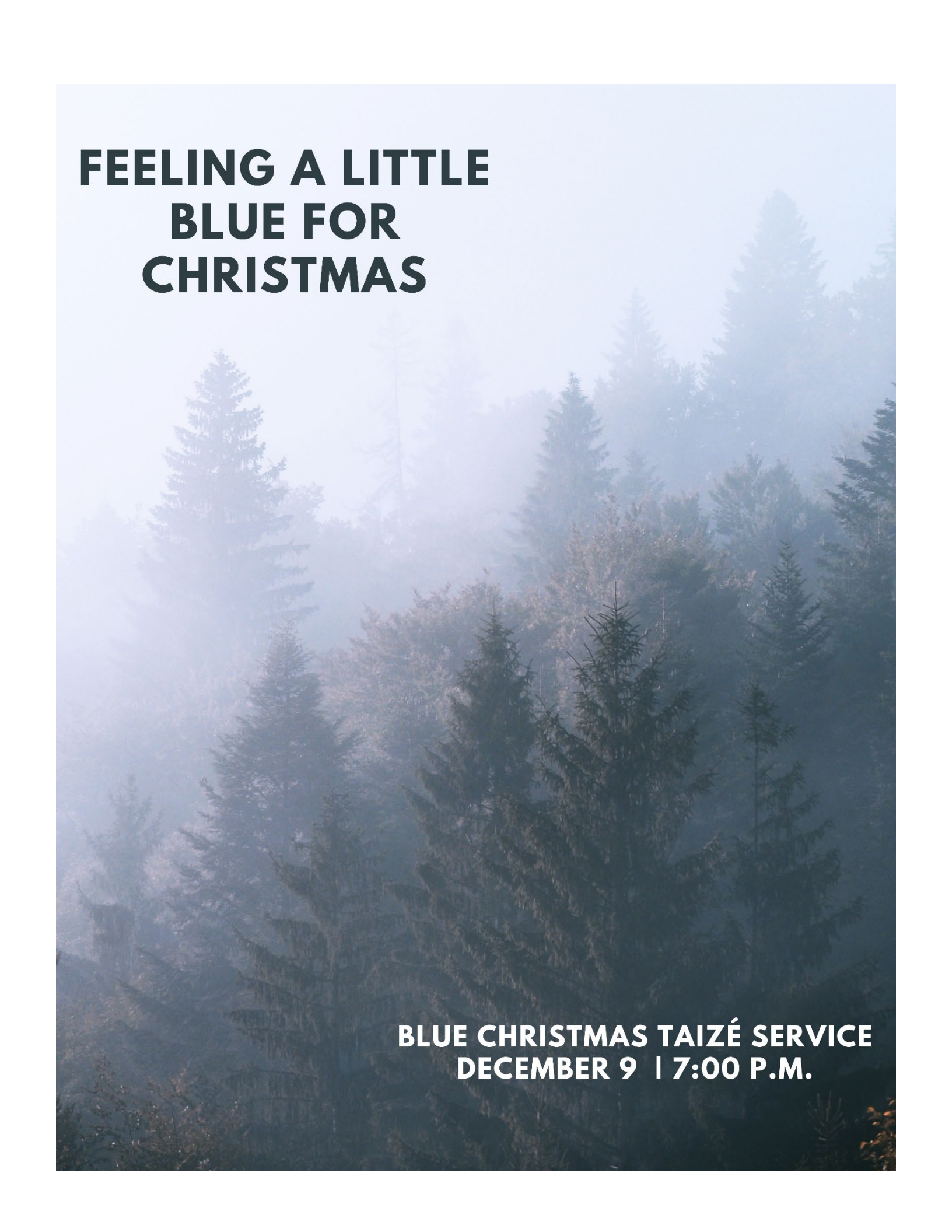


A photograph of a dense forest of evergreen trees, likely spruce or fir, shrouded in a thick mist or fog. The trees are dark green and silhouetted against a lighter, hazy background. The overall mood is serene and somewhat melancholic, fitting the 'feeling a little blue' theme.

FEELING A LITTLE BLUE FOR CHRISTMAS

**BLUE CHRISTMAS TAIZÉ SERVICE
DECEMBER 9 | 7:00 P.M.**

Order of Service

Welcome

Song

The United Methodist Hymnal #221

“In the Bleak Midwinter”

Christina G. Rossetti (1872) Gustav Holst (1906)

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Opening Prayer

Creator God, lover of the universe, we come to you in this quiet place seeking your reassurance and your hope. We come in the midst of noise, listening for your gentle heartbeat. For those who are chilled by grief and pain, bring the warmth of your love. For those who are overwhelmed by feelings that exhaust and stifle, bring the cooling breeze of your love. For those who are caught in the glare of expectations, bring the comforting darkness of your love. For those who find themselves in shadows of anxiety bring the morning dawn of your love. Breathe courage into our day. Whisper strength into our dreams. We ask these things in the name of your child, Jesus, who was born of a woman into a chaotic world of birth, death, and rebirth – just like today. *Amen.*

Silent Meditation

Song

Songs & Prayers from Taizé #20, pg. 42

“O Lord, Hear My Prayer”

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Scripture Lesson

Matthew 2:16-18

Song

Songs & Prayers from Taizé #28, pg. 49

“Come and Fill”

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Words of Reflection

Silent Meditation

Song

The Faith We Sing #2095

“Star - Child”

Shirley Erena Murray, Carlton R. Young, © 1994 Hope Publishing Co.
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Lighting of Candles

In the Bleak Midwinter

David Lasky, © 2010 Augsburg Fortress
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Song

The United Methodist Hymnal #376

“Dona Nobis Pacem”

traditional Latin
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Silent Meditation

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

Our Creator, God in heaven, hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom✱ come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power and the glory forever. *Amen.*

✱ *kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Song

Songs & Prayers from Taizé #37, pg. 56

“Within our Darkest Night”

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Sending Out With Hope

Join us January 13th at 7 p.m. and the second Friday of each month (Oct-May).

Worship Leaders

Julie Darlington and Kristin Southworth, cantors

Pat Lyall, cello

Jenny Ammerman, keyboard

Anders Nelson, piano and organ

Rev. Becky Sechrist, Pastor

Taizé Cross (from a traditional Russian Orthodox Icon) by Robert Wagner & Larry Harvey

Sanctuary setting by Kristin Southworth & Jenny Ammerman

Welcome Friends! We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey.
We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race,
sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

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